

Element A: Presentation and Justification of the Problem

People can easily lose things such as wallets, identification cards, phones, etc. from their pockets and need a way to keep things in their pockets because those items fall out of their pockets easily. Anyone who has had items fall out of their pockets would be involved in our project. This problem occurs everywhere in the world, from at home to traversing a big city. People often lose items from their pockets because their pockets are too small, so the items do not fully fit into the pockets.

Many people around the world lose items that were stored in their pockets, and spend time and money to find those lost items, and sometimes never find them. Our team wants to fix this problem at its root, making people less likely or not at all able to lose stuff from it falling out of their pocket. So, our team's problem is focused towards fixing losing items such as wallets, identification cards, or phones, because they fell out of their owner's pockets. This problem can be applicable to many more items, such as pens, pencils, loose change, loose bills, et cetera.

Solving this problem would make stakeholders less likely to lose items. It would also be convenient for them, as our stakeholders would not have to allocate time to looking for those items or returning them to their owners rather than something more important. An unintended consequence would be if the design itself fell off or got lost. Another could be that people would be less likely to put their names onto things, as it would be less likely to lose those things.

Mr. B is a stakeholder who is also a faculty member at our school who issues out student IDs, as well as replacements for those. Mr. H is a stakeholder who is a teacher at our school who recently broke an expensive biking computer because it fell out of his

pocket. Ms. Ca and Ms. Cr are stakeholders who are staff members at our school who are in charge of the school's lost and found.

According to a blog post from Rachel Nipp, "the average American loses something about 5 times per month." From that same blog post, there are also many statistics such as hours spent searching for lost items per year, average amount of items lost per year, items that Americans lose the most, and most common places those are found. (Nipp, 2023)

According to a survey from MoneyTips, out of 509 people interviewed, 316 reported that they had misplaced their wallet or it had been stolen. That survey made by MoneyTips also included a lot of more information, such as the percentage of people in age groups of people that had lost their wallets, with the age range 18 years old to 29 years old losing their wallets the most. (MoneyTips, 2019)

According to a list of commonly lost items from Uber, phones, wallets, and keys are the most forgotten items. Uber also provided lists of other useful information regarding lost items, such as cities that items are most lost in, trends with items that are lost, to even time of day and what weekdays items are most likely to be lost. (Uber, 2025)

References

MoneyTips. (2019, March 28). *Survey: Nearly 2 In 3 Have Lost Or Had Stolen Their Wallet*. Chron.

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Uber. (2025, April 8). *The 2025 Uber Lost & Found Index*. Uber.

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